Operations Handbook

This handbook describes the operating policies for Ridgeline Equipment Rentals, a construction equipment rental company serving contractors across the region. It covers safety requirements, damage and liability terms, maintenance responsibilities, billing practices, and the return and inspection process.

All staff and renters are expected to be familiar with the sections that apply to them. This document is reviewed and updated once per year by the operations team. Questions about any policy in this handbook should be directed to the branch manager on duty.

SECTION 1

Safety Requirements

Every renter must complete a short equipment orientation before taking possession of excavators, skid steers, or aerial lifts. The orientation covers seatbelt use, rollover protection, load limits, and the location of the emergency stop control.

Hard hats, safety glasses, and steel-toed boots are required on the rental yard at all times. Renters operating equipment on a public road must display the orange slow-moving vehicle placard supplied at pickup.

Equipment must never be operated within ten feet of overhead power lines. If a renter is unsure about clearance, Ridgeline staff will dispatch a site inspector before the unit leaves the yard.

SECTION 2

Damage and Liability

Renters are responsible for any damage to equipment that occurs while it is in their possession, beyond normal wear and tear. For excavator buckets, teeth, and hydraulic hoses, the renter's liability is capped at a 750 dollar deductible per incident, provided the optional damage waiver was purchased at checkout.

If the damage waiver was declined, the renter is responsible for the full cost of repair or replacement, with no cap.

Equipment that is returned with mud, concrete, or debris beyond normal job site residue will be subject to a professional cleaning charge of 95 dollars, billed to the card on file. Total loss of a unit, including theft, makes the renter liable for the full replacement cost listed in the current equipment value schedule.

SECTION 3

Maintenance Responsibilities

Ridgeline performs full inspection and servicing of every unit between rentals. Renters are responsible for daily fluid checks, keeping air filters clear of debris, and reporting any unusual noise or warning light within one hour of it appearing.

Routine maintenance such as oil changes, filter replacement, and greasing of moving parts remains Ridgeline's responsibility for rentals under thirty days. For long-term rentals of thirty days or more, the renter must schedule a maintenance visit at the halfway point of the rental term.

Unauthorized repairs performed by a third party will void any remaining warranty coverage on the unit for the remainder of the rental period.

SECTION 4

Billing and Late Fees

Rental invoices are generated at the end of each billing cycle and are due within 15 days of the invoice date. Accepted payment methods are company check, ACH transfer, and major credit cards.

Equipment returned after the scheduled return time is subject to a late fee of 125 dollars per day, charged in addition to the standard daily rental rate, until the unit is physically returned to a Ridgeline yard.

Fuel is billed at the posted yard rate if a unit is returned with less fuel than it had at pickup. Disputes about an invoice must be submitted in writing within 30 days of the invoice date.

SECTION 5

Returns and Inspection

At return, a Ridgeline technician inspects the unit together with the renter and completes a condition checklist covering the body, tires or tracks, attachments, and interior controls. Both parties sign the checklist before the renter leaves the yard.

Any discrepancy between the pickup and return checklist is noted on the final invoice. Renters who disagree with an inspection finding may request a second inspection by the branch manager within 24 hours of the original return.

Equipment is considered returned only once it has passed yard inspection, not simply when it is dropped off at the gate.